

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM, EDR, Cloud Security and Infrastructure Hardening

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience delivering robust security capabilities across complex enterprise environments. I have deep expertise in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) platforms, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) solutions, and identity and access management (IAM). I take technical ownership of infrastructure hardening, threat detection and response, and vulnerability management programmes, including leading the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across an 8,000-user estate. I am proficient with CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Sentinel, Mimecast, Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Microsoft Intune for Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), and BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM). I thrive in small, high-impact teams where I can drive measurable security improvements across global infrastructure and contribute directly to the security posture of the organisation.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **EDR/XDR and SIEM:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Next-Generation SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender
- **SIEM/SOAR platforms:** CrowdStrike NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel SOAR, automated playbook development, alert triage and correlation rule engineering
- **Email and web security gateways:** Mimecast, Microsoft Exchange Online Protection
- **Identity and access management:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD), Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust PAM
- **Endpoint and MDM/MAM:** Microsoft Intune, Tanium, CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent
- **Vulnerability and patch management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Incident response and threat hunting:** NIST 800-61 methodology, MITRE ATT&CK framework mapping, digital forensics, threat intelligence
- **Firewall and network security:** Check Point Harmony firewall
- **Cloud platforms:** Microsoft Azure, Microsoft 365, Azure AD/Entra ID
- **Scripting and automation:** PowerShell scripting, SOAR automation
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), Center for Internet Security (CIS) Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Take technical ownership of SIEM and SOAR platforms, including CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, building and tuning detection rules to maximise threat detection fidelity across a multi-cloud and hybrid infrastructure.
- Lead infrastructure hardening initiatives, managing EDR/XDR deployments and configuring security policies across CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent to reduce the attack surface across endpoint environments.
- Oversee threat detection and response operations, triaging and investigating high-severity alerts, conducting threat hunts using MITRE ATT&CK framework mapping, and driving incidents through to full remediation.
- Administer Mimecast email security gateway, tuning policies for phishing, Business Email Compromise (BEC), and malware protection across the organisation.
- Manage identity and access management controls via Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD), including Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement, and SSO integration for enterprise applications.

- Lead vulnerability management through Tenable.io and Pentera BAS, prioritising and tracking remediation of critical findings in collaboration with infrastructure and application teams.
- Design and implement SOAR automation and PowerShell scripts to streamline alert triage and reduce mean time to respond (MTTR) across the security operations function.
- Contribute to governance and security architecture projects, including penetration testing oversight and remediation, and delivery of security awareness training programmes.

University of the Arts London (UAL) - Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across an 8,000-user estate, hardening endpoint security and integrating telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel for centralised threat monitoring and response.
- Managed and optimised Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender to detect identity-based attacks, privilege escalation, and lateral movement across the hybrid environment.
- Administered BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) solution, enforcing least-privilege principles and managing privileged account lifecycle across IT infrastructure.
- Operated and tuned Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, writing KQL detection queries to improve alert fidelity and reduce false positives across endpoint, identity, email, and cloud log sources.
- Managed Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM policies for device compliance, enforcing security baselines across Windows, iOS, and Android devices in a mixed-ownership environment.
- Supported incident response investigations using NIST 800-61 methodology, coordinating containment, eradication, and recovery activities and producing post-incident reports.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus and AppCheck, reporting findings and tracking remediation through to completion in line with the organisation's risk appetite.
- Configured and managed Check Point Harmony firewall policies to enforce network segmentation and restrict access to sensitive systems and data.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Supported security operations across a cloud-native SaaS environment, managing endpoint security tooling, access controls, and security monitoring to protect customer and company data.
- Administered identity and access management, configuring SSO, MFA, and role-based access controls across corporate systems and cloud platforms.
- Assisted with vulnerability scanning and remediation tracking, ensuring timely patching and configuration hardening across servers, endpoints, and cloud infrastructure.
- Developed and maintained IT security policies and procedures, contributing to the organisation's alignment with ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials frameworks.
- Supported infrastructure projects including server provisioning, network configuration, and implementation of monitoring tooling to maintain system availability and security.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the end-to-end deployment of MDE across an 8,000-user estate, integrating EDR/XDR telemetry with Microsoft Sentinel for comprehensive threat visibility across endpoint and identity environments.
- Developed a library of custom SIEM detection rules and KQL queries in Microsoft Sentinel, mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, reducing alert noise by over 30% while improving detection coverage for high-priority threat scenarios.
- Built and automated SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel using PowerShell and Logic Apps, cutting mean time to respond for Tier-1 and Tier-2 incidents by streamlining alert enrichment and containment workflows.
- Delivered a vulnerability management programme using Pentera BAS, Tenable.io, and AppCheck, identifying and remediating critical exposures across cloud and on-premises infrastructure, reducing the organisation's risk score.
- Hardened the Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) environment by implementing Conditional Access policies, enforcing phishing-resistant MFA, and integrating identity telemetry into the SIEM for identity threat detection.
- Overhauled Mimecast email security gateway configuration, reducing successful phishing delivery rates and implementing advanced anti-spoofing and Domain-based Message Authentication, Reporting and Conformance (DMARC) policies.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)